Magnetic Fields

December 9-11
Alsisar, Rajasthan

There's lots to like about Magnetic Fields this year. The festival, returning after the Covid constraints of the past few years, brings in the big guns this time with Four Tet headlining. Also in the line-up are Grandbrothers, Jossy Mitsu and the fantastically named DJ Fart. Fieldlines, a commissioned project by the festival, sees musicians from Assam's Biate tribe collaborating with Vinayak^a. While it retains its focus on electronic music, the festival is also more inclusive now. There's a wellness space there, and audio-visual performances and installations, as well as Magnetic Words, which will feature filmmaker Sushmit Ghosh and architect and writer Swati Janu, among others. Oh, and it's a camping festival, in the December cold of Rajasthan. That's always fun.



Feeding India

December 10, Mumbai

Post Malone, the famous American singer, rapper, producer—also the guy with all the face tattoos—touches down upon our shores for Zomato's Feeding India concert, a charity event that aims to combat hunger in India. It's an "awareness concert", a not-for-profit endeavour that has as its noble goal a malnutrition-free India, with tickets ranging from Rs 5,000 to a cool Rs 25,000. And while Post Malone's India debut in itself is a big enough draw, the line-up also features names such as Anuv Jain, Ritviz, Ananya Birla, and others.

DGTL

December 9-10, New Delhi
December 10-11, Mumbai

The global festival returns to India with a power-packed line-up, headlined by Solomun, the renowned house DJ making his first appearance in India, and Maribou State, a formidable English electronica duo who've been doing great things for a good decade now. The festival, which last had its hurrah in India in 2020 in Bengaluru, returns with a line-up that features a range of Indian and international acts, largely focusing on assorted subgenres of electronic music. Sustainability is big on their priorities, as is an immersive audio-visual experience.



Sunburn

December 28-30, Goa

There's always Sunburn, isn't there? The dance (and trance) music festival is an institution now, with some of the biggest names in electronic dance music (EDM) the world over popping up at the beaches of Goa each year for the festival. It's a memorable, frenetic, and often chaotic party experience for those three days, right before the new year kicks in. This time, the festival brings in Afrojack, Black Coffee, and the DJ brother-duo Dimitri Vegas and Like Mike, as also a series of DJs and producers from all over to make sure the energy levels never dip.



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have spent much of the past decade working on India's first cultural adventure video game *Antara*, including a run of spin-off transmedia performances called *Antariksha Sanchar*.

Elsewhere in India is set in a futuristic version of *Antara*'s world, one where an unnamed disaster has changed the face of civilisation as we know it. We explore this vision of India in 2079 through the eyes of a cultural cyborg named Meenakshi, who's struggling to make ends meet in a country where innovation and tradition intersect and clash in surprising ways. "We're exploring this literary genre called post-cyberpunk, which is this idea of moving beyond cyberpunk as dystopia," says Kumar. "We're trying to look for hopeful messages and resolutions of the problems we envision—the liminal space between dystopia and utopia."

The duo use their design chops—and AI art generators and a game engine—to populate this world with wonky automatons, historical costumes and Mad Max rickshaws, many built off of historical samples from museums and creative commons images. The music also follows a similar approach, building space-age club anthems out of our ancient and mediaeval cultural patrimony. Murthy spent eight months recording studio sessions with over 40 musicians from South India and Kolkata, including Gana singer Dharani, frequent Ilaiyaraja collaborator Dilruba Saroja and others. "We travelled across South India to talk to folk musicians, engage with them and their process and record bits of their performances, some of which we've used," says Murthy.

Elsewhere in India was made possible thanks to a cultural exchange grant from the British Council's India/UK Together Season of Culture 2022-23, and will also travel to the Roundhouse in London and the Adelaide Fringe festival. ■

Bhanuj Kappal